

resilience and adaptability of traditional crafts. Banaras Brocades and Sarees continue to be a global symbol of Indian textile craftsmanship.

12. Lucknow Chikan Craft (Uttar Pradesh)

Lucknow Chikan Craft, characterized by delicate white embroidery on cotton fabric, originates from Lucknow in Uttar Pradesh. Its floral designs and approximately 40 different stitches add to its uniqueness. The absence of a frame during embroidery, the use of wooden blocks for printing, and the high-quality gums and dyes contribute to the craft's finesse. Lucknow Chikan Craft, while deeply rooted in tradition, has adapted to contemporary demands, making it a timeless and sought-after art form.

13. Firozabad Glass (Uttar Pradesh)

Firozabad Glass, specifically glass bangles (Choori), has a rich history dating back to the eighteenth century. The glass industry in Firozabad has preserved its traditional techniques, with soda ash and silica being used to produce glass. The intricate craftsmanship of glassware, including flasks, containers, and decorative items, reflects the skilled workmanship passed down through generations. Firozabad Glass remains not just a craft but a living legacy of Uttar Pradesh's industrial heritage.

14. Moradabadi Metal Craft (Uttar Pradesh)

Moradabadi Metal Craft, centred in Moradabad, Uttar Pradesh, showcases the region's excellence in metalwork. Brass, aluminium, and iron are intricately crafted into various products, including utensils, home decor, and religious artifacts. The craft has adapted to modern design sensibilities while retaining its traditional essence. The Moradabadi Metal Craft is a blend of heritage and contemporary aesthetics, contributing to Uttar Pradesh's reputation as a hub of artistic metal craftsmanship.

15. Nainital's Wooden Toys (Uttarakhand)

Nainital's Wooden Toys, crafted in the scenic town of Nainital in Uttarakhand, represent the traditional art of toy-making. Using locally available wood, these toys are meticulously carved and painted with vibrant, eco-friendly colours. The craft not only serves as a source of entertainment for children but also reflects the sustainable use of local resources and the preservation of cultural heritage. Nainital's Wooden Toys stand as a testament to the harmony between nature, culture, and craftsmanship.

II. From Sankheda to Saffron: Exploring the Unique GI Marvels of India's West

Embark on a journey through India's western states, where a rich tapestry of GI products unfolds, contributing to the cultural and economic vibrancy of the region. From the spirited Feni of Goa to the intricate Patan Patola silk fabrics of Gujarat, each GI product bears testament to the craftsmanship, traditions, and ecological richness of India's western landscapes:

1. Feni (Goa)

Feni, an alcoholic beverage with a 450-year legacy, is a product of the fermentation of cashew apples from specific regions in Goa. The fertile soil and unique biodiversity of Goa lend distinctive qualities to these cashew apples. The traditional production involves careful manual selection, fermentation, and distillation without any additional ingredients. Feni holds medicinal properties, and the closely guarded trade secrets contribute to its exclusivity within the community.

2. Sankheda Furniture (Gujarat)

Sankheda, a village in central Gujarat, is renowned for its unique furniture crafted by the Kharadi community. This furniture, made entirely from teakwood, is characterized by intricate patterns and complex artwork. The process involves shaving and smoothing the wood before applying floral and abstract designs using a squirrel tail brush. The use of traditional colours like gold, silver, maroon, green, vermilion, and brown, coupled with skilled handwork, results in durable and visually stunning Sankheda furniture.

3. Alphonso (Maharashtra)

Devgad Taluka in Maharashtra's Western Ghats is synonymous with the production of the finest Alphonso mangoes known as Devgad Alphonso. Celebrated for its flavour, fruity aroma, thick pulp, low fibre content, and thin skin, the Alphonso mango matures from February to May-June. Named after Portuguese explorer Alfonso De Albuquerque, this mango variety is considered one of the world's best.



4. Nashik Valley Wine (Maharashtra)

The white and red wines produced in the Nashik district of Maharashtra are distinguished for their quality. Grapes grown in the region, situated at an elevation of 2000 to 2400 ft, possess high acidity, contributing to a perfect balance in the wines. The unique geographical conditions of Nashik result in a specific acid-sugar balance, enhancing the overall quality of the wines.

5. Kutch Embroidery (Gujarat)

Kutch embroidery is an evolving art form reflecting the complex craft and textile traditions of the nomadic Rabari tribe in Gujarat. Executed using cotton or silk thread on various fabrics, the motifs draw inspiration from daily life, ancient beliefs, and rituals. Distinctive styles include suf, khaarek, paako, Rabari, Garasia Jat, and Mutava, each having its own unique stitches. Despite their apparent simplicity, these stitches combine to create intricate and complex designs.

